

EVERYDAY MILLIONAIRE

Sandra grew up in a stable two-income household, but her family certainly wasn't rich. Her father was a foreman for a county library department, and her mother was a newspaper proofreader. She describes her family back then as having *just enough* to meet their needs. They had one car, they didn't go out to eat often, and her parents had perfected the art of frugality. Sandra even remembers the family making their own Christmas ornaments one year to save money. She says her parents' approach to finances had a huge impact on her and gave her a lifelong commitment to frugal spending and long-term saving. Those two habits have served her very, very well.

Sandra began her career as a beat cop in the 1960s, and she worked her way up to lieutenant before leaving the police department after twenty-seven years of faithful service. She married during that time, but the couple never had any kids. That left Sandra with a lot of spare time after leaving the police force, so she decided to go back to work. She had a great second career as a customer service representative for a regional airline, where she stayed for twelve and a half years. After retiring *again*, she still found herself bored at home, so she did what she'd always done: she went to work. She started a third career working as an office administrator in a doctor's office, where she still serves today.

Throughout her career, beginning with her early years in the police department, Sandra's lifelong knack for saving led her to invest in tax-favored retirement plans. When the 401(k) was introduced, she dove into it. She found that she had good instincts for investing, and she put those instincts to work in her retirement accounts and some real estate investing she and her husband did on the side. She's always kept her spending in check, telling us that she never wanted or needed to live a luxurious lifestyle. Today, although she's never received an inheritance or started her own business, Sandra and her husband are worth \$2.3 million. They've achieved financial independence slowly and steadily over the past forty years. They enjoyed their life along the way, always paying cash for whatever they needed, and now they're free to live however they want in retirement. Sandra isn't lucky. She didn't win a DNA lottery; she worked her butt off! She set a goal early in her life, and she didn't let anything or anyone get in her way. She earned her way to success, and now she's reaping the rewards.

Sandra's story is just one of thousands I've heard from other men and women, people no one ever expected to make much of their lives, build wealth, or retire with millions. But who cares what other people expected of them? Most millionaires I know aren't content with the hand they're dealt